

Comments for Planning Application DM2025/01591

Application Summary

Application Number: DM2025/01591

Address: Ambulance Station Dorset Road Belmont SM2 6JH

Proposal: Change of use from Sui Generis (Ambulance Station) to mixed use Classes F1 (Places of Worship) and F2 (Community Hub) involving the erection of a part one, part two storey front and side extension, increase in height to part of building and provision of cycle and refuse stores.

Case Officer: Polly Davidson

Customer Details

Name: Ms P P

Address: 82 - 86 Central Road Worcester Park KT4 8HX

Comment Details

Commenter Type:

Stance: Customer objects to the Planning Application

Comment Reasons:

Comment:1. Traffic generation and highway safety

The proposed use will result in a significant increase in traffic movements compared to the former ambulance station use, particularly:

regular daily visits, large peaktime arrivals and departures, intensified activity during evenings, weekends and special events.

The surrounding road network is not suitable to accommodate this increase. The proposal risks:

congestion on already busy local roads, unsafe vehicle manoeuvres, increased conflict between vehicles, pedestrians and cyclists.

The application fails to demonstrate that the local highway network can safely absorb the additional traffic.

2. Inadequate parking provision and overspill parking

The proposal does not provide sufficient onsite parking for the scale and intensity of the proposed use.

This will inevitably lead to:

overspill parking on nearby residential streets, obstruction of driveways and dropped kerbs, reduced access for residents, delivery vehicles and emergency services.

This would cause ongoing inconvenience and harm to local residents and is contrary to good planning practice.

3. Noise, disturbance and loss of residential amenity

The proposed use is likely to generate significantly higher noise levels than the former use, including:

large groups arriving and leaving at the same time, noise from gatherings, meetings and events, evening and weekend activity.

This would result in an unacceptable level of disturbance to nearby residents, particularly given the residential nature of the surrounding area.

No adequate noise impact assessment has been provided to demonstrate how residential amenity would be protected.

4. Overdevelopment and inappropriate scale

The proposed part one, part two storey extensions and increased building height represent overdevelopment of the site.

The scale, bulk and massing of the development would:

appear out of keeping with surrounding buildings, result in visual harm to the street scene, create an overly dominant and intrusive structure.

The proposal does not respect the character or appearance of the area.

5. Change in intensity of use:

The former use as an ambulance station had controlled, functional activity.

The proposed mixed use will introduce:

a much higher intensity of occupation, prolonged hours of use, frequent large gatherings.

This represents a material intensification of use that is unsuitable for this location and incompatible with nearby residential properties.

6. Insufficient servicing, refuse and management details

The application does not adequately address:

refuse storage capacity and collection arrangements, servicing and delivery times, crowd management and dispersal.

Without a clear and enforceable management plan, the development risks causing ongoing disruption and disorder.

7. Lack of robust supporting evidence

The application is not supported by sufficient technical evidence, including:

a detailed transport assessment, a parking stress survey,
a noise impact assessment, a clear operational management plan.

In the absence of this information, the local planning authority cannot properly assess the full impact of the proposal.

Conclusion

For the reasons set out above, the proposal would result in harm to highway safety, residential amenity, and the character of the area.

The development is therefore unsuitable for this location and should be refused.